

Late Start But Ponce Shooting For Majors

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Hollywood, Fla. — In spring training each year, it is customary for just about every player in camp to impress his intention of having a good season and elevating himself into the big leagues.

There is one member of the 1957 Indianapolis squad with this ambition and it may seem a bit unusual in his case. The player is Tony Ponce and he is on the books as 35 years old, somewhat late in baseball age to be shooting for the majors.

Of course, Tony may have learned something another visitor to Florida, Ponce de Leon, was trying to find out a few hundred years ago.

Ponce, a pitcher, is unusual though as it appears his right arm can whip the ball across indefinitely.

HE HAS AN effortless pitching motion and has been effective both as a starter and reliever. About 50 percent of the time he uses a knuckle ball. He has good control and knows how to pitch. Ponce, also, can be helpful at bat.

When asked how many pitches he needed to warm up, Tony replied, "two or three."

This is Ponce's 19th season in pro baseball. He, also, has participated in winter play 18 times. He didn't compete this past winter, being employed instead in a fiber box plant in Los Angeles. The Mexican-born hurler said he was doing this

type of work to "keep strong." Ponce said he doesn't believe he is too old to fill his big ambition—reaching the majors.

Tony even had a pitching pattern set out for 1957, which has not had Manager Andy Cohen's approval yet, to serve as a stepping stone to his big league chance.

Ponce's idea is that he can pitch three times a week, perhaps three innings each, that is if he isn't needed as a starter.

Tony had his stretch for durability in 1952 after posting a 15-20 record at Ventura in the California League. He was called up by San Francisco and finished the season pitching and winning eight games in 16 days.

Included was a Sunday doubleheader against Los Angeles. Ponce's earned run average for the eight games was 1.03.

IN 1951 at Phoenix, he pitched 152 innings and gave only 42 bases on balls.

Tony was asked how many

clubs he had hurled for. He scratched his head and replied, "Twelve or 13 I guess."

HIT AND RUN — The Indians will resume their Sunan League campaigning at Hollywood this afternoon against Buffalo. The Tribe's record is 5-1 and they have "buffaloed" the Bisons three out of four times.

A four and a half-hour workout was held yesterday with Manager Cohen and Hugh Mulcahy, White Sox farm camp supervisor, directing work on fundamentals. There, also, was a intrasquad game of five innings. The Hutchinsons, directed by Ira Hutchinson, Colorado Springs manager, defeated the Hutchings, 6-3.

A visitor here is Joe Hauser, taking time off from his sporting goods store in Sheboygan, Wis. Hauser set the all-time American Association home run record of 69 while at Minneapolis in 1933. He was a Minneapolis teammate of Cohen's for five seasons.

Billy Meyer, Ex-Major, League Baseball Manag

Knoxville, Tenn. (INS)—Billy Meyer, who waited 22 years in the minors before he became a major league manager, died yesterday in a Knoxville hospital. He was 65.

Meyer's major league managerial days like his playing

